

A Job Simulation Report
Of
Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation

(Hosted on the Forage Virtual Experience Platform)

Submitted

To

School of Computer Science and Engineering
IILM University, Greater Noida, U.P.

In partial fulfilment of the requirement of degree of
B.Tech (Computer Science and Engineering)

By

Roll Number of Student: 2410030327

Name of Student: MOHD ALI HAIDER

Batch: 2024-2028

Candidate's Declaration

I, MOHD ALI HAIDER, do hereby declare that the job simulation report titled “Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation” has been completed by me to fulfil the requirement for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering. All the references have been quoted and I have not taken as such any material from any other source. I affirm that this report is my own and has not been submitted to any other institute for any degree/diploma requirement, and further I shall be solely responsible for any kind of copyright violation in this regard.

Signature:-

Student Name: MOHD ALI HAIDER

Roll No.: 2410030327

Acknowledgement

I am using this opportunity to express my gratitude to everyone who supported me throughout this job simulation. I am sincerely grateful for the structured, practical learning experience provided by Forage and Mastercard, which gave me a risk-free way to experience the kind of work carried out by a Security Analyst on a Security Awareness team.

I would like to thank Forage for hosting this virtual work-experience programme and Mastercard for designing and sponsoring the Cybersecurity Job Simulation. I am also thankful to my institute, IILM University, Greater Noida, and the faculty of the School of Computer Science and Engineering for their continuous support and encouragement.

I express my gratitude to my parents for their blessings.

Signature:-

Student Name: MOHD ALI HAIDER

Roll No.: 2410030327

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3. Internship Completion Certificate



Inspiring and
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Mohd Ali Haider Cybersecurity Job

Certificate of Completion
September 20th, 2026

Over the period of September 2026, Mohd Ali Haider has completed practical tasks in:

Design a phishing email simulation
Interpret phishing simulation results



Tom Brunskill
Co-Founder of Forage

Enrolment Verification Code 6aaf9aec8b93e7892aeee166 | User Verification Code 6aaf98858b93e7892aee862f | Issued by Forage

4. Project Description

4.1 Introduction

This report presents an account of the Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation, a virtual work-experience programme hosted on the Forage platform and completed in September 2026. The simulation is designed to give participants a realistic, risk-free introduction to the day-to-day work of a Security Analyst on Mastercard's Security Awareness team, without requiring a prior technical background. It is self-paced and centres on one of the most common threats faced by organisations today – phishing – and on the practical steps a security team takes to reduce its impact.

The simulation was undertaken as a self-directed practical exercise to build foundational cybersecurity awareness and to strengthen employability skills relevant to the Computer Science and Engineering programme at IILM University, Greater Noida.

4.2 Organization Profile

Forage is a virtual work-experience platform that partners with global employers to let students and early-career professionals practise the kind of tasks performed inside a real company, at their own pace and free of cost. Mastercard sponsors its Cybersecurity Job Simulation on this platform as part of a wider commitment, alongside other large employers, to widen access to career-relevant skills. Through the simulation, Mastercard shares an inside view of how its Security Awareness team designs phishing-awareness exercises and uses the results to protect employees and the organisation from social-engineering attacks.

4.3 Problem Statement

Phishing remains one of the most common and most effective ways that cybercriminals gain a foothold inside an organisation, and defending against it depends as much on employee awareness as on technical controls. Many students understand phishing only as a term from coursework and rarely get hands-on exposure to how a real security-awareness team designs a simulated phishing exercise or interprets its results to target future training. This simulation addressed that gap by placing the participant in the position of a Security Analyst asked to (a) turn an obviously fake phishing email into a more convincing exercise, and (b) interpret the outcome of such an exercise to recommend follow-up training.

4.4 Objectives of the Simulation

- To understand the threat that phishing poses to an organisation and its employees.
- To recognise the characteristics of different types of phishing emails and distinguish them from legitimate correspondence.
- To learn how Mastercard approaches phishing prevention and mitigation at an organisational level.
- To design a phishing email simulation that could plausibly be used to raise employee awareness.
- To interpret the results of a phishing simulation and translate them into targeted, effective security-awareness training recommendations.

4.5 Scope of the Simulation

The scope of this exercise was limited to two self-paced practical tasks delivered through Forage's simulated Mastercard environment. It covered the identification of red flags in a sample phishing email, the editing of that email to make it more convincing for internal testing purposes, and the analysis of simulated campaign results to identify which teams needed further training. The exercise was conducted entirely within a virtual, sandboxed learning environment and did not involve access to, or testing against, any live production system, real employee data, or an actual organisation.

4.6 Skills and Tools Used

- Security awareness and phishing-threat analysis
- Problem solving and design thinking
- Written communication and documentation
- Data analysis and data visualization
- Security-training strategy and recommendation

4.7 Task 1 – Designing a Phishing Email Simulation

The first task involved examining a deliberately obvious, low-effort phishing email supplied as a starting point and revising it so that it would more convincingly resemble a genuine phishing attempt used for internal awareness testing. This required identifying the elements that typically give phishing emails away – mismatched sender addresses, generic greetings, urgent or threatening language, and suspicious links or attachments – and then adjusting the tone, formatting, and framing of the email so that it would realistically test employees' ability to spot such attempts. The output was a documented, revised phishing-simulation email suitable for use by Mastercard's Security Awareness team.

4.8 Task 2 – Interpreting Phishing Simulation Results

The second task involved reviewing the outcome data from a simulated phishing campaign – such as which employees or teams clicked the simulated link or reported the email as suspicious – and interpreting that data to identify where employees were most at risk. Based on this analysis, the task required recommending which teams should receive targeted phishing-prevention training and how that training should be prioritised, translating raw simulation results into a practical, actionable security-awareness plan.

4.9 Learning Outcomes

- Ability to recognise common red flags in phishing emails and explain why they indicate a phishing attempt.
- Practical understanding of how a security-awareness team designs and runs a phishing simulation.
- Ability to interpret simulation data and turn it into a targeted training recommendation.
- A stronger appreciation of social-engineering risk and the human side of cybersecurity defence.
- Successful completion of both practical tasks, resulting in the award of a Certificate of Completion by Forage.

4.10 Certificate of Completion and Verification

The Certificate of Completion issued by Forage, confirming successful completion of the Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation, is attached in Chapter 3 of this report. The certificate records the enrolment verification code 6aaf9aec8b93e7892aeee166 and the user verification code 6aaf98858b93e7892aee862f, issued by Forage and countersigned by Tom Brunskill, Co-Founder of Forage.

5. Bibliography / References

1. Forage, “Mastercard Cybersecurity Job Simulation – Certificate of Completion,” Enrolment Verification Code: 6aaf9aec8b93e7892aeee166, User Verification Code: 6aaf98858b93e7892aee862f, September 2026.
2. Forage – Mastercard Cybersecurity Virtual Experience Program, <https://www.theforage.com/simulations/mastercard/cybersecurity-t8ye>
3. Forage, “Showcase your skills. Find your career fit.”, <https://www.theforage.com/>